

Cheng (Kevin) Shao

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EDUCATION

University of Waterloo

B.A.Sc. Electrical Engineering, Honours, Co-op

Waterloo, ON

September 2025 - Expected May 2030

EXPERIENCE

Electrical Team Member

Jan. 2026 – Present

University of Waterloo Baja SAE Team

Waterloo, ON

- Integrating and testing a Data Acquisition (DAQ) system using Arduino, MPU6050 accelerometers, and RPM sensors
- Designing custom PCBs and developing an upgraded 18V battery setup to regulate internal electrical components
- Researching and coding strain gauges to extract live telemetry data, aiding in comprehensive system calibration
- Fabricating space-efficient wire harnesses and designing circuit schematics for 2026 competition vehicles

Project Team Member

Winter 2026

Waterloo Experience (WE) Accelerate Program

Remote

- Conducted accessibility and usability audits of five co-op community pages to identify UI/UX failures
- Developed digital accessibility micro-course modules focusing on accessible HTML, CSS, and web design
- Evaluated digital environments for strict AODA compliance and WCAG standard adherence

Manual Labour Worker

Dec. 2024 – Jul. 2025

Vanderkooi Farm

Nanaimo, BC

- Collaborated with a fast-paced team to execute large-scale livestock transfer operations
- Processed over 20,000 chickens per shift while strictly adhering to humane handling requirements
- Maintained high performance and reliability during intense, high-volume seasonal peak periods

Room Maintenance Worker

Summers 2022 – 2025

Mapleview B&B

Nanaimo, BC

- Managed guest accommodations and property arrangements with a high standard of cleanliness
- Handled listing coordination and guest communication, securing consistently positive reviews

PROJECTS

RPM Monitoring Device | *ESP32, C++, HW-477 Hall Effect Sensor*

Jan. 2026 – Present

- Engineered a custom rotational speed sensing solution using an ESP32 and an HW-477 Hall Effect sensor
- Developed firmware to process analog magnetic signals and calculate accurate, real-time RPM telemetry
- Integrated the sensor array into a broader vehicle DAQ framework to optimize off-road performance

Smartwatch Sleep Monitor | *ECE 198 Design Project, Arduino, C++*

Sep. 2025 – Dec. 2025

- Prototyped a wearable Arduino UNO R4 and oximeter sleep tracker to address hospital-induced delirium
- Programmed firmware to detect sleep cycles via heart rate variability thresholds (Start < 55, End > 65 BPM)
- Implemented IoT functionality to transmit automated daily sleep reports to caregivers via Wi-Fi
- Validated system reliability, confirming accurate heart rate logging and successful email data delivery

Trades & Mechanical Projects | *VIU Trades Program*

Sep. 2024 – Feb. 2025

- Electrical:** Fabricated extension units from technical schematics, ensuring CSA grounding compliance
- Mechanical:** Performed automotive maintenance and brake replacements, prioritizing workshop safety
- Woodworking:** Fabricated custom products using industrial power tools and precision finishing
- Welding:** Utilized thermal cutting and welding to fuse metals with high structural integrity

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Programming/Firmware: C++, HTML, Arduino (Wiring)

Hardware & Tools: ESP32, Arduino, Accelerometers (MPU6050), Multimeters, Soldering, Power Tools

Relevant Skills: Circuit Assembly, PCB Design, Wire Harnessing, Data Acquisition (DAQ), Technical Documentation

Spoken Languages: English (Fluent), Mandarin (Fluent Speaking/Listening, Intermediate Reading/Writing)